

Creative Thinking

Same AI. Better angle.

Picture every kid in your class typing nearly the same question into AI for the same assignment. They all get back something polished. They all sound the same. The grader has read it eight times before lunch. That sameness is the problem this lesson is about.

By now you can work the tool and check what it gives back. This is the part the tool cannot do for you. What makes your work yours is the angle you bring to the problem before AI ever sees the question.

CREATIVITY ISN'T JUST ART

Creativity gets mistaken for being artistic. That's a small slice of it. The bigger version is a way of thinking. It's the habit of finding the angle no one else saw, in whatever room you're in.

WHO THINKS CREATIVELY

None of these jobs are usually called creative. Every one of them rewards the person who brings the angle nobody else brought.



Creative lawyer

Finds a strategy nobody else read in the same case file. Same laws, same facts, different play.



Creative entrepreneur

Spots a gap in the market everyone else walked past. The product isn't new. The angle on it is.



Creative engineer

Solves a problem the standard textbook approach can't crack. The fix wasn't in any manual.



Creative doctor

Catches a diagnosis everyone else missed. Same symptoms, different read.

Creativity isn't a job title or a personality trait. It's a habit of thinking that runs underneath any job worth doing.

HOW CREATIVE PEOPLE THINK

The good news: creative thinking isn't a gift some people get handed. It's a set of moves you can practice. Run these five enough times and they become automatic.

Five moves you can practice

1

See the obvious.

Name the play everyone else is going to land on before you try to leave it.

2

Question the assumption.

Find the one nobody is questioning and ask what happens if it isn't true.

3

Connect the unconnected.

New angles come from putting two unrelated things next to each other.

4

Push past the first decent idea.

Average ideas come first. Interesting ones come fourth or fifth.

5

Pick the angle and own it.

Creative thinking ends in a choice. Commit to one and back it.

AI DOES THE TASK.

You bring the angle. Everyone in the room has access to the same tool. What makes your work yours is what you brought to it before AI ever showed up.

AI widens the options.

You still pick the better angle.